

On 21 October 2022, the National Management Group (NMG) met to consider the response to the Emergency Plant Pest (EPP) *Euwallacea fornicatus* (Polyphagous shot-hole borer, PSHB)/*Fusarium* sp. AF-18 complex in Western Australia.

Earlier, on 18 October 2022, *E. fornicatus* and the associated symbiotic *Fusarium* sp. were formally classified as category 1 EPPs.

The NMG endorsed a three-year Response Plan to eradicate *E. fornicatus*/*Fusarium* sp. AF-18 complex from Western Australia, with an upper limit of expenditure set at \$39.99 million.

The Response Plan is being nationally cost-shared under the Emergency Plant Pest Response Deed (EPPRD).

Euwallacea fornicatus/*Fusarium* sp. AF-18 complex was formally notified under the EPPRD on 3 September 2021. The NMG recognised the extensive work that Western Australia has undertaken to date on emergency surveillance, tracing, containment, and eradication.

Based on international data, *E. fornicatus*/*Fusarium* sp. complex has over 680 known host species which it can potentially damage. These species comprise horticulture production, native, and amenity trees. The adult beetles and their larvae can be hard to spot as they spend most of their lives inside a tree. The signs that indicate the borer could be found include multiple entrance holes in the trunk or branches or wilting or dying branches. Further information about PSHB/*Fusarium* complex is available on the outbreak.gov.au website.

If you live in Western Australia and think you have a tree showing signs of infestation with PSHB, please contact the Exotic Plant Pest Hotline on 1800 084 881 or report it through the Department of Primary Industries and Regional Development (DPIRD) MyPestGuide Reporter app.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/about/news/stay-informed/communiques/euwallacea-fornicatus-fusarium-sp-af-18-complex-21-oct-22>